

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

CPS still struggling to fix gap in budget

No solution for \$734M deficit as deadline to finalize plan looms

By Kate Armanini and Kate Perez
Chicago Tribune

Chicago Public Schools officials have yet to identify a solution for the district's looming \$734 million deficit, as the August deadline to finalize a spending plan fast approaches.

In an update at a Chicago Board of Education meeting Thursday, CPS Chief Budget Officer Michael Sitkowski reiterated the district has identified \$165 million in spending reductions, including cuts to its administrative staff, vendor contracts and operational efficiencies.

That leaves CPS with just a few weeks to balance its books, facing hundreds of millions of deficit. Sitkowski told the board that the district is prioritizing cuts that have less impact on the classroom.

"We are working hard to be able to develop a plan that keeps the pressure off of our schools, that keeps the pressure off of things that impact the student experience," Sitkowski said. "There is still work to do on our end. We're still doing that on a daily basis."

The district is mandated by the state to approve a budget by Aug. 28. Officials released a budget plan in May, but that was banking on \$300 million in funds from the city or state that has yet to materialize.

School-level budgets, or the specific allocation of money to each school, were released earlier this month — already pushed back from June. Several board members expressed concern that CPS has yet to identify a concrete solution to its fiscal woes.

"I'm sort of baffled that we are at this point, three weeks away from the need to present a budget, that we're talking in generalities rather than in numbers and more

Turn to CPS, Page 4



Feeling the heat

Extreme temperatures can pose a danger to both baseball players and fans — and are changing physics of the game

By Kalen Lumpkins and Adriana Pérez
Chicago Tribune

The Kansas City Royals were hot Wednesday at Wrigley Field, scoring an 8-4 road win.

So were the Cubs. And the umpires. And the fans. Everyone felt the heat in Wrigleyville.

Fans swarmed to the Addison Red Line station after the game, waiting as the humid 90-degree heat beat down on them. Riders in their sweat-stained Pete Crow-Armstrong jerseys squeezed onto the train, turning each car into a sauna room.

"If you wear a fur coat, you'll die," said Cubs fan Lee Kesselman, 73, while waiting in front of Gate 1.

Extreme summer heat during baseball season is not only making games uncomfortably hot and sweaty for fans in the stands — it's also posing a danger to the health of players and changing the physics of the sport.

Since 1970, human-made climate change has driven up average summer temperatures in Chicago by 2 degrees, according to the climate science nonprofit Climate Central. That

lines up with an average increase of 2.8 degrees across 26 Major League Baseball home cities in the United States — except Los Angeles. The home of the Angels and Dodgers has had no measurable change in baseball season temperatures since 1970.

Across the Midwest, with a 3.6-degree increase each, Cleveland, Detroit, Milwaukee and St. Louis are some of the top 10 MLB cities that have undergone the most warming.

In a June 21 Cubs game against the Mariners at Wrigley Field,

Turn to Heat, Page 5



CITY SERIES MATCHUP MATTERS:
The combi-

nation of the White Sox's mini-surge and the Cubs' yielding pole position to the Brewers makes this late July City Series, which begins Friday on the South Side with an Adrian Houser-Shota Imanaga matchup, the most intriguing in years. **Paul Sullivan in Chicago Sports**

Above: Paul Siegfried, of Plainfield, cools off under a hose outside the firehouse on Waveland Avenue after the Cubs-Royals game Wednesday at Wrigley Field. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**



Michael McClain, second from left, a lobbyist and confidant of ex-House Speaker Michael Madigan, leaves the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse after being sentenced Thursday. **BRIAN CASSELLA/TRIBUNE**

Judge hands ex-ComEd lobbyist 2 years in prison

Calls McClain's bribery scheme with Madigan a 'criminal alliance'

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

Michael McClain, a long-time lobbyist for utility giant Commonwealth Edison who was also a close confidant of then-House Speaker Michael Madigan, has always insisted that what federal prosecutors claimed was an elaborate scheme to bribe the powerful speaker was nothing more than relationship-building.

But at McClain's long-

awaited sentencing hearing Thursday, a judge called it a "false narrative" to suggest what McClain did was time-honored legal lobbying or simply passing along job recommendations from a politician.

If it was aboveboard, U.S. District Judge Manish Shah said, why would he try to conceal it so elaborately?

"Aligning with Mr. Madigan made good strategic sense from your point of view, but

that was a criminal alliance," Shah said. "You preferred secrecy and lies. You preferred Mr. Madigan. You chose his way, and the consequences of that choice are yours to bear."

Minutes later, Shah handed McClain a two-year prison sentence for his central role in a scheme to funnel hundreds of thousands of dollars in no-work contracts and other perks to Madigan associates in

Turn to McClain, Page 2

Tension builds over renovation at the Fed

Powell pushes back at revised price tag alleged by president

By Christopher Rugaber, Josh Boak and Chris Megerian
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — After months of criticizing Federal Reserve Chair Jerome Powell, President Donald Trump took the fight to the Fed's front door Thursday, publicly scorning the central bank chief over the ballooning costs of a long-planned building project. Powell pushed back, challenging the president's latest price tag as incorrect.

Wearing hard hats and grim faces in the middle of the construction project, Trump and Powell addressed the cameras. Trump charged that the renovation would cost \$3.1 billion, much higher than the Fed's \$2.5 billion figure. Powell, standing next to him, shook his head "no."

The Fed Chair, after looking at a paper presented to him by Trump, said the president was including the cost of renovating a separate Fed building, known as the Martin building, that was finished five years ago.

The visit represented a significant ratcheting up of the president's pressure on Powell to lower borrowing costs, which

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HULK HOGAN 1953-2025



JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE 2024

Superstar led pro wrestling to new cultural heights

Hulk Hogan, a mustachioed, headscarf-wearing icon in professional wrestling who turned the sport into a massive business and cultural touchstone, died Thursday at 71. Hogan, whose real name was Terry Bollea, was perhaps the biggest star in WWE's history. His "Hulkamania" starting running wild in the mid-1980s and pushed pro wrestling into the mainstream. **Nation & World in Business, Page 8**

10 years after closure, school gets 2nd life

Robert Emmet Elementary in Austin has been transformed into community center and workforce development facility. **Business**

Marvel world-savers take care of business

Ten years after a "Fantastic Four" movie that wasn't, Marvel gives us "The Fantastic Four: First Steps," a much better couple of hours. **A+E**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 80 Low 72

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
178th year No. 206 © Chicago Tribune

